

Figure 3.17 *Killigan, eastern Yakaulang District, Bamiyan Province: detail of ornamentation in room on south wall. From Lee 2006: fig. 32.*

advantage of other usable structures in Bamiyan, and Danestama could have been another such act of architectural pragmatism.[66]

But not all Shansabani intervention in the Bamiyan region involved pre-existing structures. At variance with Zuhak and possibly Danestama, and the numerous ruins to the west of Bamiyan, the fortified hilltop site of Sarkhushak (Figures 3.23–3.26) apparently had no pre-Islamic architectural fabric in its extensive remains. Located to Bamiyan's north and commanding a promontory at the confluence of the Bamiyan and Shibar rivers (Figures 3.8 and 3.23), the site's principal construction probably took place during the Shansabani ascendancy in Bamiyan, or the second half of the twelfth century, likely having later phases of occupation as well.[67] Documentation of the site identified the remains of two residential/palatial structures[68] – one with multiple interconnected stories sophisticatedly arranged on a gradient (Figure 3.24); one mosque, and a tomb with a *mihrab*[69] (Figure 3.25); a possible *hammam*; a quadrangular and apparently fortified structure with circular corner bastions[70]; and about forty artificial grottoes in a spur of the rocky promontory.

As with the other Bamiyan-area complexes, more systematic exploration is also needed here. But it is still apparent that Sarkhushak's mosque and tomb architecture utilized domical profiles, three-pointed arches,